NSF I-Corps
Customer Interview Form

NSF I-Corps Team:	**Team #003, Fruitful Network Development**				
Entrepreneurial Lead:	Dylan Montgomery	Mentor:		Faculty Lead:	

Customer Interviews

Market Segment:	**Agricultural Network: Farmer's Market Consumer**

Customer Name:	*Email:*	*Phone:*	*Date Contacted:*
Carol Ricks		773-896-####	04 /12 /2025
Company Name:	Yellow Bird Food Shed	*Job Title:*	Operation Director

What 1 or 2 hypotheses are you trying to test in this interview? (Hypotheses are statements, not questions; they often start with "I think…")	**Market Validation (Speaking to industry individuals):** - **What are the current distribution needs and solutions for the AGNET** - **What are the current supply needs and solutions for the AGNET**
Use the space provided to list prepared questions, with space below each for notes, for your interview.	**Goals:** - **To understand the potential customer's top 2-3 problems** - **To understand the potential customer's current processes** - **To understand further downstream implications of the problem** - **To understand try to quantify the severity of the problem** - **To understand the limitations of the customer's current solutions** - **To understand the decision-making process** - **To understand what the current budget is for solving the problem** --- **Question:** - **What technological uses and costs (Website, Software, Service portals, Phones, Internet, Email, Hardware, POS, ect.)** - **What considerations are there in expanding operations?** - **What problems have you faced with short shelf life and fragile products?** - **How are internal operations challenged for a family farm (Software/hardware)?** - **And externally for family farms or other Network individuals?** - **Trouble Finding Produce** - **How'd you find places** - **Frustrations** - **What Health Factors are prioritized** - **What info do you wish you new about suppliers** --- **Notes:** - **Visits farmers markets every week in the summer** - **In the winter goes to Trader Joes, Costco, Auldys, Wholefoods** - **Initially tried using local Farmers market but they did not have a good wide selection for a one stop shop** - **Drove to visit different markets before finding one that offered wide variety of produce** - **Talked to each vendor and asked about pesticide use, plastic use, herbicide use and tried to find vendors that had good practices** - **Trust the people that they see every week and has relationships with** - **Wish there were markets similar to the Cleveland Westside market so they produce from other areas of the US that have similarly good practices could/ Local greenhouse produce could be sold in the winter** - **Goes out of her way to pickle products and freeze for use in other seasons**

What were the key things you learned from this conversation? Summarize your takeaways here.	**Notes:** **- I didn't realize the environment was such a large motivator for peoples investment in shopping locally and sustainably. I knew that it was a factor, but now hearing it from the Yellow Bird Food Shed, in addition to Carol. Plastic is a big downside for shoppers as they don't want the waste.** **uaicorps@gmail.com** **More notes on next page:**
General Notes and jotted down ideas	**Technology** **- Framework (Similar to React native and pushing to system)** **1. Store, Serve, Curate, and Browse modularization** **2. Independent interface-profile to curators-profile** **3. Industry Union - Scale unscalable-replicable practices with nodal computerized margin optimization** **- What this 'data alphabet' does is create a platform for information that is much more contextualized in its structure and logistical in how something is described, the same way alphabetical writing systems use language-roots and how all writings contextualizes itself with grammar and paragraph breaks. This platform of information works induction with open source programming and crowd training/employment of AI, however what it does best is create a sustainably volatile software development arena. This sustainable and volatile nature is crucial for all industries to hope to be taken to a next level. When an individual can succeed just as fast as they fail.** **- I am trying to assist small businesses to operate more efficiently in cost and time as it pertains to their use of digital tools and presence online and in a community.** **- The purpose of decentralization is separate from issues of efficiency and decision making. It does not, at its core, assert a change of decision making, but rather action and ability to take action at a level the same level of coordination as centralized systems.** **Check out:** **- Chamber commerce, Agricultural Extension Programs, Cyberling family and zales, PBFS, Suncrest, Farmers Markets, Unions, HOAs** **Segment and Market Considerations (Financial Risks):** **- Environmental (Weather, Pest or disease)** **- Production and Operational Risk (Distribution, Equipment)** **- Overhead Costs (Input, Labor,)** **- Price and Market Risk (Selling Price, Demand)** **- Financial Risk** ** - Interest rates** ** - Credit availability**